



(R to L) Vineet Sahni, Rohini Sahni, daughter-in-law Rhea, and son Vyom

same manner. “We are all unique, and nature has made us like that. One does not weigh gold, diamonds, and coal on the same scale. That said, gold, diamond, and coal have their unique properties.” “There is nothing so unequal than giving equal treatment to unequal,” he quips.

The dark horse theory is also something he believes in a lot. He has seen more than enough dark horses working in his experience and is sure that these are the “champions” that turn the fates of organisations. The best way of identifying a dark horse, he says, is by looking for individuals who do not say much but are always trying to do more with passion.

He highlights, “I have never let anyone in my management team touch these dark horses. I tell them to let them work as they want to, and not once have they put down my faith.

One more critical experience shaping Sahni’s life is understanding power’s true meaning. Though his dad had taught him how power commands respect, he has, with time, learned all this respect is not ‘true’. “People around you become extra sweet when you are in a position of power. It is always good to go by the gut. Keep yourself grounded and surround yourself with people who are true to you,” he says. Change your course if the people around you are negative.

Sahni adds, “When wanting to explore the truth about an organisation, always speak to people who work at the lowest levels of designations. They will, most of the time, speak the truth. Some people in management positions learn to manage truths in ways that are comfortable for them.”

A touchwood family!

During 1989-90, while working with Tata Motors, Sahni was posted in Jammu. Despite the incidents of terrorism he witnessed, there are some things he did not want to discuss, but he credits that tenure for making him a man of principle and discipline.

“We were working on some projects with the Indian defence forces and hence made many friends in the army. How small things matter and are of the greatest relevance is something nobody other than the Indian army can teach you,” he says. He explains instances where he would talk to his friends in the army and ask them if they wanted him to bring something for them from Delhi.

They would request that I bring fresh vegetables, post a letter on their behalf to their families, and bring some Bollywood CDs. They used to live in subzero conditions, and access to these small things was a luxury,” he explains.

He also credits everything he has achieved so far in life due to his wife’s role. Rohini Sahni, a PhD in Biotechnology, and Vineet have had an arranged marriage. There was a time when Sahni wrote his wife a 10.7 metres (35 feet) long love letter packed in a heart-shaped box with a cassette full of romantic songs.

Sahni sent that to the university hostel his future wife was residing in, and a professor opened the same. “That’s a story for some other time, but we still laugh about that incident!” Rohini runs an educational centre in Delhi where students are

Man of many firsts!

Also known as a “man of many firsts,” Vineet Sahni, through his sheer vision and determination, has achieved many things in his career for the first time in the industry. He has led by example by creating a wonderful team.

- Starting self-reliance journey in technology
- Opening international design offices in Asia and Europe
- Global acquisition of two-wheeler and four-wheeler lighting company in just one year
- Localisation of products through greenfield and brownfield manufacturing facilities in record time
- Bringing in new technology to India and many more